

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Architecture Foundations and Harappan Urbanism - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Architecture Foundations and Harappan Urbanism	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — HOW TO READ ARCHITECTURE Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function;
02	FOUNDATION — GRID PLANNING AND PRE-PLANNING Evidence chain: Rectangular grid Qualified use: Open a Harappan
03	FOUNDATION — CITADEL AND LOWER TOWN The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the
04	CORE — BRICK MODULES AND COORDINATION Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared
05	CORE — THE DRAINAGE NETWORK Evidence chain: Maintainable drainage Qualified use: Make civic
06	CORE — WATER INSIDE THE HOUSE Evidence chain: Domestic water design Qualified use: Show ordinary
07	CORE — GREAT BATH AND RITUAL INFERENCE Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure
08	CORE — PUBLIC BUILDINGS AND LABELS Evidence chain: Conventional granary label - No confirmed palace or
09	CORE — DHOLAVIRA'S REGIONAL SOLUTION Evidence chain: Dholavira adaptation - Official Dholavira linkage
10	CORE — LOTHAL, HARAPPA AND KALIBANGAN Evidence chain: Lothal basin caution - Harappa and Kalibangan
11	CORE — THE SCRIPT AND INFERENCE CEILING Evidence chain: Undeciphered-script boundary Qualified use: Answer
12	CORE — MELUHA AND EXCHANGE Evidence chain: Meluha and external contact Qualified use: Add an
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — CIVIC VERSUS MONUMENTAL COMPARISON Evidence chain: Civic versus monumental priority Qualified use: Create
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — PYQ AND WATER-ARCHITECTURE BOUNDARIES Classification: Historical facts below are source-backed, causal weight

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Architecture Foundations and Harappan Urbanism - Solved Practice Workbook 5

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 5

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Architecture reading axes?	5
Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Architecture reading axes?	5
Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Architecture reading axes?	5
Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Architecture reading axes?	5
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Rectangular grid?	6
Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Rectangular grid?	6
Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rectangular grid?	6
Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rectangular grid?	6
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Citadel and lower town?	7
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Citadel and lower town?	7
Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Citadel and lower town?	7
Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Citadel and lower town?	7
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Standardised burnt brick?	8
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Standardised burnt brick?	8
Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Standardised burnt brick?	8
Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Standardised burnt brick?	8
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Maintainable drainage?	9
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Maintainable drainage?	9
Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Maintainable drainage?	9
Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Maintainable drainage?	9
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Domestic water design?	10
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Domestic water design?	10
Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Domestic water design?	10
Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Domestic water design?	10
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Great Bath?	11
Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Great Bath?	11
Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Great Bath?	11

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Great Bath?	11
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Conventional granary label?	12
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Conventional granary label?	12
Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Conventional granary label?	12
Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Conventional granary label?	12
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies No confirmed palace or temple?	13
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under No confirmed palace or temple?	13
Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of No confirmed palace or temple?	13
Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about No confirmed palace or temple?	13
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Dholavira adaptation?	14
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Dholavira adaptation?	14
Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dholavira adaptation?	14
Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dholavira adaptation?	14
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Lothal basin caution?	15
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Lothal basin caution?	15
Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Lothal basin caution?	15
Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Lothal basin caution?	15
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Harappa and Kalibangan variation?	16
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Harappa and Kalibangan variation?	16
Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Harappa and Kalibangan variation?	16
Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Harappa and Kalibangan variation?	16
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Standardisation inference?	17
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Standardisation inference?	17
Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Standardisation inference?	17
Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Standardisation inference?	17
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Undeciphered-script boundary?	18
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Undeciphered-script boundary?	18
Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Undeciphered-script boundary?	18
Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Undeciphered-script boundary?	18
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Meluha and external contact?	19
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Meluha and external contact?	19
Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Meluha and external contact?	19

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Meluha and external contact?	19
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Civic versus monumental priority?	20
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Civic versus monumental priority?	20
Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Civic versus monumental priority?	20
Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Civic versus monumental priority?	20
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Verified 2025 Mains demand?	21
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified 2025 Mains demand?	21
Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified 2025 Mains demand?	21
Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified 2025 Mains demand?	21
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Water-architecture firewall?	22
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Water-architecture firewall?	22
Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Water-architecture firewall?	22
Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Water-architecture firewall?	22
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Official Dholavira linkage?	23
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Official Dholavira linkage?	23
Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Official Dholavira linkage?	23
Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Official Dholavira linkage?	23
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Harappan answer spine?	24
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Harappan answer spine?	24
Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Harappan answer spine?	24
Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Harappan answer spine?	24
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	25
VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	25
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	25
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 GS-I	25
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	25
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	26
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	26
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	26
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	27
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	27

Architecture Foundations and Harappan Urbanism - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Architecture reading axes?

A. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. B. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. C. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. D. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.

Answer: A. Explanation: Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Architecture reading axes?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. C. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. D. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste.

Answer: B. Explanation: Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Architecture reading axes?

A. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. B. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. C. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. D. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system.

Answer: C. Explanation: Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Architecture reading axes?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. C. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. D. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis.

Answer: D. Explanation: Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Rectangular grid?

A. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. B. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. C. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. D. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.

Answer: A. Explanation: Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Rectangular grid?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.

Answer: B. Explanation: Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rectangular grid?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. C. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. D. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture.

Answer: C. Explanation: Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rectangular grid?

A. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. B. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference.

Answer: D. Explanation: Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Citadel and lower town?

A. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. B. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.

Answer: A. Explanation: The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Citadel and lower town?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact.

Answer: B. Explanation: The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Citadel and lower town?

A. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. B. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. C. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. D. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture.

Answer: C. Explanation: The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Citadel and lower town?

A. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. B. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. C. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. D. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste.

Answer: D. Explanation: The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Standardised burnt brick?

A. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. B. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system.

Answer: A. Explanation: Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Standardised burnt brick?

A. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. B. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact.

Answer: B. Explanation: Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Standardised burnt brick?

A. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. B. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. C. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. D. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact.

Answer: C. Explanation: Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Standardised burnt brick?

A. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. B. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. C. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. D. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.

Answer: D. Explanation: Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Maintainable drainage?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact.

Answer: A. Explanation: House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Maintainable drainage?

A. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. B. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. C. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. D. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name.

Answer: B. Explanation: House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Maintainable drainage?

A. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. B. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. C. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. D. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name.

Answer: C. Explanation: House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Maintainable drainage?

A. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. B. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. C. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. D. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system.

Answer: D. Explanation: House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Domestic water design?

A. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. B. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. C. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. D. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact.

Answer: A. Explanation: Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Domestic water design?

A. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. B. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. C. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. D. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name.

Answer: B. Explanation: Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Domestic water design?

A. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. B. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally.

Answer: C. Explanation: Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Domestic water design?

A. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. B. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. C. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. D. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture.

Answer: D. Explanation: Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Great Bath?

A. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. B. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. C. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. D. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Great Bath?

A. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. B. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. C. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. D. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Great Bath?

A. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. B. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. C. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. D. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Great Bath?

A. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. B. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. C. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. D. Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact.

Answer: D. Explanation: Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Conventional granary label?

A. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. B. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. C. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. D. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally.

Answer: A. Explanation: Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Conventional granary label?

A. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. B. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. C. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. D. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally.

Answer: B. Explanation: Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Conventional granary label?

A. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. B. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. C. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. D. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally.

Answer: C. Explanation: Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Conventional granary label?

A. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. B. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. C. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. D. Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name.

Answer: D. Explanation: Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies No confirmed palace or temple?

A. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. B. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. C. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. D. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally.

Answer: A. Explanation: No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under No confirmed palace or temple?

A. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. B. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. C. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. D. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire.

Answer: B. Explanation: No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of No confirmed palace or temple?

A. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. B. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. C. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. D. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded.

Answer: C. Explanation: No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about No confirmed palace or temple?

A. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. B. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. C. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. D. No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality.

Answer: D. Explanation: No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Dholavira adaptation?

A. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. B. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. C. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. D. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally.

Answer: A. Explanation: Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Dholavira adaptation?

A. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. B. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. C. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. D. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dholavira adaptation?

A. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. B. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. C. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. D. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dholavira adaptation?

A. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. B. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. C. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. D. Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Lothal basin caution?

A. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. B. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. C. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. D. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement.

Answer: A. Explanation: Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Lothal basin caution?

A. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. B. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. C. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. D. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded.

Answer: B. Explanation: Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Lothal basin caution?

A. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. B. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. C. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. D. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples.

Answer: C. Explanation: Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Lothal basin caution?

A. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. B. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. C. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. D. Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally.

Answer: D. Explanation: Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Harappa and Kalibangan variation?

A. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. B. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. C. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. D. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument.

Answer: A. Explanation: Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Harappa and Kalibangan variation?

A. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. B. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. C. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. D. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument.

Answer: B. Explanation: Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Harappa and Kalibangan variation?

A. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. B. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. C. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. D. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential.

Answer: C. Explanation: Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Harappa and Kalibangan variation?

A. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. B. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. C. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. D. Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement.

Answer: D. Explanation: Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Standardisation inference?

A. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. B. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. C. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. D. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded.

Answer: A. Explanation: Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Standardisation inference?

A. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. B. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. C. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. D. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential.

Answer: B. Explanation: Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Standardisation inference?

A. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. B. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. C. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. D. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Standardisation inference?

A. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. B. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. C. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. D. Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire.

Answer: D. Explanation: Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Undeciphered-script boundary?

A. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. B. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. C. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. D. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples.

Answer: A. Explanation: The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Undeciphered-script boundary?

A. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. B. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. C. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. D. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes.

Answer: B. Explanation: The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Undeciphered-script boundary?

A. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. B. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. C. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. D. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration.

Answer: C. Explanation: The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Undeciphered-script boundary?

A. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. B. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. C. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. D. The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded.

Answer: D. Explanation: The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Meluha and external contact?

A. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. B. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. C. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. D. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes.

Answer: A. Explanation: Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Meluha and external contact?

A. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. B. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. C. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. D. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Meluha and external contact?

A. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. B. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. C. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. D. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit.

Answer: C. Explanation: Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Meluha and external contact?

A. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. B. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. C. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. D. Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument.

Answer: D. Explanation: Indus seals in Mesopotamia support long-distance trade contact; the identification of the Harappans with Mesopotamian Meluha remains a scholarly argument. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Civic versus monumental priority?

A. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. B. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. C. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. D. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration.

Answer: A. Explanation: Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Civic versus monumental priority?

A. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. B. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. C. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. D. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit.

Answer: B. Explanation: Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Civic versus monumental priority?

A. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. B. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. C. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. D. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit.

Answer: C. Explanation: Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Civic versus monumental priority?

A. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. B. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. C. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. D. Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples.

Answer: D. Explanation: Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Verified 2025 Mains demand?

A. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. B. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. C. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. D. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit.

Answer: A. Explanation: The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Verified 2025 Mains demand?

A. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. B. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. C. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. D. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration.

Answer: B. Explanation: The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Verified 2025 Mains demand?

A. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. B. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. C. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. D. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit.

Answer: C. Explanation: The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Verified 2025 Mains demand?

A. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. B. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. C. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. D. The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential.

Answer: D. Explanation: The verified 2025 GS-I question asks for the salient features of Harappan architecture in 150 words, making selection and evidentiary caution essential. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Water-architecture firewall?

A. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. B. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. C. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. D. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit.

Answer: A. Explanation: Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Water-architecture firewall?

A. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. B. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. C. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. D. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit.

Answer: B. Explanation: Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Water-architecture firewall?

A. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. B. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. C. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. D. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference.

Answer: C. Explanation: Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Water-architecture firewall?

A. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. B. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. C. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. D. Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes.

Answer: D. Explanation: Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Official Dholavira linkage?

A. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. B. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. C. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. D. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference.

Answer: A. Explanation: UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Official Dholavira linkage?

A. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. B. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. C. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. D. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste.

Answer: B. Explanation: UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Official Dholavira linkage?

A. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. B. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. C. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. D. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste.

Answer: C. Explanation: UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Official Dholavira linkage?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. C. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. D. UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration.

Answer: D. Explanation: UNESCO's official Dholavira property page describes planned urban areas, fortifications, reservoirs and drainage; it is used only as current official corroboration. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Harappan answer spine?

A. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. B. Architecture is read through material, plan, elevation and function; patronage, ecology and evidence limits convert description into analysis. C. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. D. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference.

Answer: A. Explanation: A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Harappan answer spine?

A. Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference. B. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. C. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. D. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.

Answer: B. Explanation: A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Harappan answer spine?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste. C. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. D. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.

Answer: C. Explanation: A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Harappan answer spine?

A. House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system. B. Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm. C. Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture. D. A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit.

Answer: D. Explanation: A high-value answer moves from grid to zoning, public works, drainage, material and regional variation, then closes with the palace-temple evidence limit. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

One direct Mains demand is verified: 2025 GS-I on the salient features of Harappan architecture. Its wording is reproduced only from the routed repository owner; no additional PYQ is invented.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

7. Exact PYQ application

FACT: 2025 Q1, verbatim: "Discuss the salient features of the Harappan architecture. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 1.txt:8-10). **ANALYSIS:** A strong 150-word answer should: (i) open by naming the grid-plan town layout; (ii) describe citadel/lower-town differentiation with the granary/Great Bath example; (iii) describe the drainage system as the civilisation's most distinctive feature; (iv) close with the standardised- brick observation and the honest caveat that no confirmed palace or temple structure has been identified. **WRONG:** No 2024 Mains question directly tests this topic.

8. Exact PYQ application

FACT: 2025 Q1, verbatim: "Discuss the salient features of the Harappan architecture. (Answer in 150 words)" (UPSC Mains 2025 GS Paper 1.txt:8-10). **ANALYSIS:** An advanced-tier answer should differentiate itself from a basic answer by explicitly noting the evidentiary caution around "palace"/"temple" labelling, and by using the comparative point (functional civic investment vs. Egyptian/Mesopotamian monumentalism) as its analytical edge - while still keeping to the 150-word limit by stating this in one tight sentence rather than an extended digression. **WRONG:** No 2024 Mains question tests this topic directly.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2025 GS-I

Demand: Discuss the salient features of the Harappan architecture. (Answer in 150 words)

Status: Verified verbatim in the Basic and Advanced owners.

Model solution: Open with planned grid and zoning; add standardised burnt brick, public works and the house-to-street drainage network; qualify labels such as granary; conclude that no palace or temple is securely identified.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Discuss the salient features of Harappan architecture. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Harappan architecture was civic rather than dynastic-monumental: a grid, functional zoning, standardised brick, public water works and maintainable drainage reveal coordinated urban norms, while no palace or temple is securely identified.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference.
- The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste.
- Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.
- House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system.
- Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact.
- No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality.

Qualified conclusion: Harappan architecture was civic rather than dynastic-monumental: a grid, functional zoning, standardised brick, public water works and maintainable drainage reveal coordinated urban norms, while no palace or

temple is securely identified.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why is drainage central to an assessment of Harappan urbanism? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Its importance lies in the network from house to street and in provisions for cleaning, which show continuing civic maintenance rather than an isolated engineering object.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system.
- Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture.

Qualified conclusion: Its importance lies in the network from house to street and in provisions for cleaning, which show continuing civic maintenance rather than an isolated engineering object.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Harappan standardisation operated through regional adaptation. Analyse. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Shared grids, bricks and water logic were translated into Mohenjo-daro's bath, Dholavira's reservoirs, Lothal's basin and regional plans rather than copied identically.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Harappan streets commonly ran north-south and east-west and met at right angles, making pre-planning rather than organic accretion the central inference.
- Harappan builders used standardised burnt mud bricks laid in layers and joined with gypsum mortar, indicating a shared technical norm.
- Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation.
- Lothal's basin is conventionally called a dockyard, but its precise function remains debated and must be presented conditionally.
- Harappa's large brick platforms and Kalibangan's distinctive planning prevent Mohenjo-daro from becoming an identical template for every settlement.
- Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire.

Qualified conclusion: Shared grids, bricks and water logic were translated into Mohenjo-daro's bath, Dholavira's reservoirs, Lothal's basin and regional plans rather than copied identically.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: To what extent can architecture reconstruct Harappan society? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Built form supports strong claims about planning, labour and hygiene, weaker claims about differentiation, and no settled claims about named rulers or religion because the script is undeciphered.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The upraised western citadel held large public structures, while the larger lower town was predominantly residential; this is functional zoning, not proof of caste.
- Raised platforms and ventilation support a storage interpretation, but 'granary' remains a modern archaeological label rather than an ancient attested name.
- No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality.
- The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded.

Qualified conclusion: Built form supports strong claims about planning, labour and hygiene, weaker claims about differentiation, and no settled claims about named rulers or religion because the script is undeciphered.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Compare Harappan urban priorities with contemporary monumental traditions. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The contrast is between repeated civic infrastructure and securely attested royal-sacred monumentality elsewhere; it suggests different visible priorities without proving Harappan irreligion or egalitarianism.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- No large structure has been securely identified as a Harappan palace or temple, distinguishing the evidence from Egyptian and Mesopotamian royal-sacred monumentality.
- Harappan surplus is most visible in streets, drains, wells, baths and storage rather than confirmed royal tombs or temples.
- Repeated bricks, grids and drainage imply coordination or a shared technical culture, but do not by themselves prove one centralised empire.
- The undeciphered-script boundary is the evidentiary limit created by the absence of readable Harappan texts and securely named buildings; reconstructions of rulers, religion and social order therefore remain graded.

Qualified conclusion: The contrast is between repeated civic infrastructure and securely attested royal-sacred monumentality elsewhere; it suggests different visible priorities without proving Harappan irreligion or egalitarianism.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine water architecture in the Harappan city and distinguish it from later Indian water structures. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Harappan wells, baths, drains and reservoirs formed settlement systems; later stepwells and temple tanks answered aridity, patronage and ritual, so resemblance of medium does not establish continuity of function.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- House drains joined larger covered street drains with cesspits and removable covers, so maintenance was built into the civic system.
- Private wells, ventilated bathrooms and stairs indicating some double-storeyed houses placed water and hygiene within ordinary domestic architecture.
- Mohenjo-daro's Great Bath was a large public water structure surrounded by rooms and galleries; ritual cleansing is a plausible inference, not an inscriptional fact.
- Dholavira combined a fortified multi-part settlement with reservoirs and water-harnessing systems, proving that shared Harappan norms allowed regional adaptation.
- Harappan water works were settlement-wide civic infrastructure; later stepwells and temple tanks served different ritual, commemorative or storage purposes.

Qualified conclusion: Harappan wells, baths, drains and reservoirs formed settlement systems; later stepwells and temple tanks answered aridity, patronage and ritual, so resemblance of medium does not establish continuity of function.